

24GDCV00235 24GDCV00235

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 3

Hearing date: 2026-09-23

Motion: MOTION FOR ATTORNEY FEES

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Case Number: 24GDCV00235 Hearing Date: September 23, 2026 Dept: 3

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF
CALIFORNIA

FOR THE COUNTY OF LOS ANGELES - NORTHEAST
DISTRICT

GERMAN
PEREZ GARCIA, et al.,

Plaintiff(s),

vs.

FORD
MOTOR COMPANY, et al.,

Defendant(s).

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CASE NO.: 24GDCV00235

[TENTATIVE]

ORDER RE: MOTION FOR ATTORNEY FEES

Dept.

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8:30

a.m.

September

23, 2026

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I.

INTRODUCTION

On April 16, 2026, plaintiffs German

Perez Garcia and Andrea Martinez Negrete (collectively, "Plaintiffs") filed

this motion for an attorneys' fee award in the amount of \$77,364.38, consisting

of \$58,691.50 in fees for Quill & Arrow, LLP ("QA"), a 1.25 multiplier

enhancement of \$14,672.88, and an additional \$4,000 for Plaintiffs' counsel to

review the opposition brief, prepare the reply, and attend the hearing on this

motion.

Defendant Ford Motor Company

("Defendant") filed an opposition brief on September 10, 2026.

Plaintiffs filed a reply brief on September 17, 2026.

II.

DISCUSSION

Plaintiffs' attorneys and paralegals

billed at hourly rates ranging from \$175 to \$950, with most billing around \$350 to \$500. In the Court's experience, these rates are reasonable. Defendant argues these rates should be reduced to a range of \$250 to \$400 for attorneys and a maximum of \$100 for law clerks or paralegals, and refers the Court to a spreadsheet attached to the Declaration of Saed Atallah for proposed reductions. Notably, Defendant does not argue that any of the billing entries were duplicative or excessive; rather, the spreadsheet simply notes that the hourly rate of each timekeeper should be reduced. However, Defendant does not include any evidence supporting its proposed rates, such as declarations from attorneys in the community or its own defense counsel.

In the Court's experience, the hourly rates charged by QA are reasonable and the amount of time spent on this case, 142.40 hours, is reasonable considering that litigation lasted over two years, involved a dispositive motion, and required trial briefs and motions in limine to be filed. The Court therefore grants a base lodestar of \$58,691.50, along with an additional \$2,425.50 for time spent to review Defendant's opposition brief and prepare the reply brief. The Court declines to award a multiplier because there is no showing that the case required any exceptional skill, beyond that possessed by counsel and reflected in the hourly billing rate, or that it required Plaintiffs' counsel to turn down other work.

III.

CONCLUSION

Accordingly, Plaintiffs' motion is GRANTED in part and the Court issues an award of \$61,117 in fees.

Dated
this 23rd

day of September 2026

William A.
Crowfoot

Judge of the Superior Court

Parties who intend to submit on this tentative must send an email to the Court at ALHDEPT3@lacourt.org indicating intention to submit on the tentative as directed by the instructions provided on the court website at www.lacourt.org. Please be advised that if you submit on the tentative and elect not to appear at the hearing, the opposing party may nevertheless appear at the hearing and argue the matter. Unless you receive a submission from all other parties in the matter, you should assume that others might appear at the hearing to argue. If the Court does not receive emails from the parties indicating submission on this tentative ruling and there are no appearances at the hearing, the Court may, at its discretion, adopt the tentative as the final order or place the motion off calendar.